

# ARMY MARS BASIC TRAINING COURSE (BTC)

## AM-7 Skill Level (SL) 1

May 2023

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release: distribution unlimited.

The Army MARS Basic Training Course (BTC) is the foundation of initial training for Army MARS (AMARS) Candidates. This manual sets the standard for the candidate's knowledge and skills required to operate within radio networks. AMARS candidates are required to complete the BTC training successfully within six-months of joining AMARS and will earn the title of Auxiliarist on completion.

### In this course, you will:

- Onboard into Army MARS. This course will serve as your Orientation into the Army MARS.
- Reference the Army regulations, AMARS manuals, and other supplemental documents.
- Work closely with your mentor.
- Demonstrate proficiency in the Mission Essential Tasks (MET) required for successful operation as an AMARS station.

AMARS training and performance consists of four different levels that are described in AM 7, *Training and Performance Assessment Plan*. The Basic Training Course is the first level in this training and is referred to as Level 1.

### Instructions:

- The Training Officer will assign a mentor to each candidate to help facilitate the learning process. The mentor will be an experienced and knowledgeable MARS Auxiliarist that is capable of providing guidance to the candidate.
- The Training Officer, and Mentor will work as a team to provide the guidance, detailed instruction and operational opportunities necessary for the candidate to complete this course successfully.
- The candidate will complete each of the Level 1 METs to standard within the first 6 months of membership. To accomplish this, the candidate will study the references and doctrinal material listed on each MET and participate in MARS activities.
- The Training Officer and Mentor will evaluate the candidate's performance on each of the Level 1 METs and ensure the candidate can perform the tasks to standard. The Training Officer will complete DA Form 5164-R to document the candidate's completion of each MET.

The left margin of this manual provides space to write notes and will also provide helpful study tools. These icons will help point you to the necessary resources and highlight key information.



Resources



Key  
Take Away



Study Ideas



Additional  
Notes:



Information for  
Trainers or Mentors

- A good working relationship between the candidate, Training Officer and Mentor will make completion of the BTC a rewarding and enlightening experience.

The Army MARS BTC will assist you in developing your operating skills and technical abilities and prepare you to achieve proper operation and performance of your MARS station. Level 1 are the minimal skills and knowledge in order to operate on military nets and provide the necessary foundation to continue training at Level 2.

## Independent Learning

The BTC appendix is for AMARS candidates to progress through at their own learning pace with assistance from a Mentor. Because not all candidates need the same level of instruction in all areas, the BTC does not contain all the instructional material required to complete all tasks; rather, the BTC provides references to more detailed instructions.

The BTC is comprised of twelve Level 1 METs. In the process of completing the twelve tasks, there are three forms of assessments: certified training, open-book multiple-choice assessments and the practical application of performing various radio operator tasks.

The following is a breakdown of the Level 1 METs:

- Provide training certificate for Incident Command System (ICS) 100.
- Onboarding and Orientation: Includes a review of AM 1, This is Army MARS, AM 6, Net Plan
- 11 MARS performance-based tasks

Each MET is represented by a Task Sheet. The Task sheet is a standardized format that describes exactly what needs to be done to perform and evaluate the task.

Figure 1 - Completed DA Form 5164R

## Each task sheet is broken down into the following sections

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| <b>Task Number: (example)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <b>Task Title: (example)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |              |
| <b>Action:</b><br>The Action specifies what you will do need to do in order to successfully complete the task.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |              |
| <b>Condition:</b><br>The Condition describes the learning environment – the tools which will be provided or omitted, time constraints, and the like. Think of it as the scenario in which the task is to be completed.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |              |
| <b>Standards:</b><br>The Standards provide the criteria used to measure if the task has been mastered.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |              |
| <b>Training and Evaluation:</b><br>Training and evaluation provides the specific steps or instructions to take in order to complete or be credited for the task.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |              |
| <b>Performance Measures (PM):</b><br>Performance Measures provides reference for the trainer or mentor to evaluate whether the task has been successfully completed.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <b>GO</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <b>NO GO</b> |
| <b>References:</b><br>References list the material that will need to be referenced in order to successfully complete the task. Related references are also listed and may be helpful but are not required reading. Identifying the relevant doctrine, technical and field manuals for operating a military radio station enables MARS Auxiliaries to respond to new situations without depending on leadership to provide direction, and is a primary training objective. | <b>Related</b><br>Some references required to complete this course are sensitive in nature. This information is available through your Training Officer or Mentor. All other references are available at:<br><a href="http://www.usarmymars.org/resources/">http://www.usarmymars.org/resources/</a> |              |
| <b>Warnings:</b><br>Warnings will provide information regarding safety hazards or any specific cautions that should be taken when completing the task.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |              |
| <b>Notes:</b><br>Additional Information                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |              |

## Mission Essential Tasks Online Training Course

AMARS Candidates are required to show proof of completion of basic National Incident Management System (NIMS) training. The NIMS course is the same as those required of Public Safety/First responders for their agencies to receive Federal funding. These courses provide a basic understanding of the higher-level management systems that span across multiple agencies and disciplines.

The Federal Emergency Management Agency provides the training at its website noted below. Upon completion, the candidate will receive a certificate by email.



### Resources

<https://training.fema.gov/is/>



### Additional

#### Notes:

The FEMA course may have been completed at any time prior to evaluation.

All previous versions of the course are acceptable.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |                                                       |           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Task Number: SL1-1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |  | Task Title:<br>National<br>Incident Management System |           |
| Action:<br>Validate completion of NIMS/ICS course                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  |                                                       |           |
| Condition:<br>Given a valid email address and internet access to the fema.gov website:<br><a href="https://training.fema.gov/is/">https://training.fema.gov/is/</a>                                                                                                                       |  |                                                       |           |
| Standards:<br>Show certificate of completion of the NIMS ICS-100 (IS-100) course.                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  |                                                       |           |
| Training and Evaluation: <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Candidate completes the course at any time prior to evaluation. Current and all previous versions of the courses are acceptable.</li><li>• Candidate submits copy of training certificates to Training Officer</li></ul> |  |                                                       |           |
| Performance Measures (PM):<br><br>Provide Trainer copy of IS-100 course completion certificate.                                                                                                                                                                                           |  | GO                                                    | NO-<br>GO |
| Evaluation Guidance:<br>Candidates passing all PMs receive a GO. If the candidate does not meet any PM, demonstrate the correct procedure, and describe how to do it correctly. Have the candidate perform the PMs until they achieve the standard.                                       |  |                                                       |           |
| References:<br>Required <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Self-contained course information at: <a href="https://training.fema.gov/is/">https://training.fema.gov/is/</a></li></ul>                                                                                                 |  |                                                       |           |
| Warnings:<br>None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  |                                                       |           |
| Notes:<br>On-line training and certification                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |                                                       |           |

## Orientation

The Orientation is completed after a multiple-choice exam of key facts researched in the Army MARS manuals and knowledge-based topics. These are open book, on-line assessments hosted at the [www.usarmymars.org](http://www.usarmymars.org) website.

The tasks are structured to familiarize the Candidate with the manuals that establish doctrine in AMARS. The candidate is not expected to fully digest the entire contents of these manuals, rather demonstrate they can use the appropriate manual to research topics as required. MARS Auxiliaries use these references to research and expand their knowledge about the MARS program at any time questions arise.



**Information for Trainers and Mentors:**

Successful completion of this section will require significant one on one discussion between mentor/ trainer and the Candidate.

Make time either in person or by telephone to discuss topics.



**Resources:**

<https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources>



**Additional Notes:**



**Key Takeaway**

Comprehension of Admin requirements and behavioral expectations for MARS Auxiliaries.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |                                   |          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|-----------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Task Number:</b> SL1-2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |  | <b>Task Title:</b><br>Orientation |          |
| <b>Action:</b><br>Complete Orientation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |                                   |          |
| <b>Condition:</b><br>Given: a valid email address and internet access to all references and the Army MARS Website:<br><a href="https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources">https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |  |                                   |          |
| <b>Standards:</b><br>The candidate will:<br><ol style="list-style-type: none"><li>1. Correctly identify the conditions, requirements and responsibilities of Army MARS Auxiliarists</li><li>2. Correctly describe the organization and chain of command</li><li>3. Correctly identify and describe mission related tasks and the supported entities, including conditions for supporting DSCA and HADR.</li><li>4. Correctly describe the technical requirements and specifications for operating a MARS station</li><li>5. Correctly identify and describe behavioral expectations and prohibited activities, including OPSEC, Information Assurance and Privacy.</li></ol> |  |                                   |          |
| <b>Performance Steps:</b><br><ol style="list-style-type: none"><li>1. Take the Basic Training Course Assessment on <a href="https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources">https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources</a> website and answer all 25 questions correctly.</li><li>2. Receive email confirmation indicating the candidate provided correct responses to all questions.</li></ol>                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  |                                   |          |
| <b>Training and Evaluation:</b><br>The candidate demonstrates successful completion of the PM to the Trainer or Mentor                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |                                   |          |
| <b>Performance Measures (PM):</b><br>The candidate provides the Trainer copy of online examination score sheet indicating all questions were answered correctly                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  | GO                                | NO<br>GO |
| <b>Evaluation Guidance:</b><br>Candidates passing all PMs receive a GO. If the candidate does not meet any PM, demonstrate the correct procedure and describe how to do it correctly. Have the candidate perform the PMs until they achieve the standard.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |  |                                   |          |
| <b>References:</b><br><b>Required</b><br>AR 25-6, <i>Military Auxiliary Radio System</i><br>AM 1, <i>This is Army MARS</i> .<br>AM 6, Army MARS NETPLAN                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |                                   |          |
| <b>Warnings:</b><br>None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |                                   |          |

## Performance-Based Assessments



### Information for Trainers and Mentors:

Army MARS requires the use of the government provided communications software MSC. MSC allows for a standardized approach to operations and training throughout MARS.

Trainers and Mentors may provide advice, relate experience and inform the Candidate about the performance of these tasks, but are not to install and configure software for members. It is necessary that members can perform these tasks independently and without assistance.



### Resources:

Tasks MSC1-1 through MSC 1-7 are included in the MSC Training Course Feb 2021 (or later).

Your MARS teammates have all accomplished these tasks and can offer technical advice. You should use them, explain where you are stuck and follow their advice to complete these steps.



### Additional Notes:

| Task Number: SL1-4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |  | Task Title:<br>Install and Configure MSC |                    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>Action:</b><br>Install and Configure MSC Software.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |                                          |                    |
| <b>Condition:</b><br>Given: A personal computer with a 64 bit operating system, Windows 10 or later.<br>Ability to perform tasks in the Windows operating system.<br>Access to the internet and website <a href="https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources">https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources</a><br>Possession of the valid installer passphrase<br>RGN_AB.csv file<br>A thumb drive or other appropriate recovery media<br>MARS Standard Communications (MSC) Training Course Feb 2021 or later.                                                                                                                |  |                                          |                    |
| <b>Standards:</b><br>1. Store MSC installer media for later use<br>2. Correctly installs the Communications Processor (CP), Message Creator (MC), Message Machine (MM), Response Collector (RC), and MSC Chat (CC) applications.<br>3. Configures CP, MC, MM and RC applications according to MSC tasks 1-6<br>4. Creates a recovery back up of the MSC installation according to MSC task 1-7                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |                                          |                    |
| <b>Performance Steps</b><br>Perform the following steps without assistance:<br>1. According to the Performance Steps in MSC 1-1, install and test CP, MC, MM and RC applications.<br>2. According to the Performance Steps in MSC 1-2, configure the CP application<br>3. According to the Performance Steps in MSC 1-3, configure the MC application<br>4. According to the Performance Steps in MSC 1-4, configure the RC application<br>5. According to the Performance Steps in MSC 1-5, configure the MM application<br>6. According to the Performance Steps in MSC 1-6, configure the CC application<br>7. According to the Performance Steps in MSC 1-7, creates a recovery back up |  |                                          |                    |
| <b>Training and Evaluation:</b><br>The mentor or trainer will provide the candidate:<br>a. The MSC Training Course<br>b. The installer passphrase sheet<br>c. The RGN_AB.csv file<br>d. A Request Strip to test RC<br>e. Individualized instruction and feedback<br>The Candidate demonstrates successful completion of the PM to the Trainer or Mentor                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |                                          |                    |
| <b>Performance Measures (PM):</b><br>1. Refers to the instruction manuals provided in each application.<br><br>2. Successfully completes MSC tasks 1-1 through 1-7 according to the Performance Measures for each task.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  | GO<br><br>GO                             | NO-GO<br><br>NO-GO |
| <b>Evaluation Guidance:</b><br>Candidates passing all PMs receive a GO. If the candidate does not meet any PM, demonstrate the correct procedure and describe how to do it correctly. Have the candidate perform the PMs until they achieve the standard.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |                                          |                    |
| <b>References:</b><br><b>Required</b><br><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>MSC Training Course Feb 2021 (or later) <a href="https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources">https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources</a></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |  |                                          |                    |
| <b>Warnings:</b> None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |                                          |                    |





## Information for Trainers and Mentors:

The Mentor will facilitate a discussion of the video content referenced below:



## Resources:

The MSC Key-Loader is only available by direct email through the Region's AMARS leadership.

The key pass-phrase sheet is only available by direct email through the Region's AMARS leadership.

These items are kept close hold to current AMARS Auxiliaries in good standing as they contain cryptographic material. These materials are not available to download.

The Key-Loader software installer and Pass-phrase sheet are both required to unlock a key. They are never distributed together.



## Additional Notes:

The "Software Archive" referred to should be removable media such as a thumb drive or removable hard drive that is stored in a physically secure location such as a locked desk drawer.

**Task Number:** SL1-5

**Task Title:**  
Load Encryption Keys

### Action:

Install or Update encryption keys in MSC. Including Emergency Key Change.

### Condition:

Given: A personal computer and the ability to perform tasks in the Windows operating system.  
Possession of the valid installer passphrase for the key loader.  
Key Loader installer program for the current year provided by Region AMARS leadership.  
Possession of Passphrases for the required keys. If required, the passphrase to open the locked pdf file which contains these passphrases.  
Has already correctly installed and configured the MSC Communications Processor application. MSC Task 1-1 and 1-2.

### Standards:

1. The candidate retains MSC Key-Loader Installer and passphrase sheet for later use
2. The candidate applies the passphrase to unlock the Key Loader Installer.
3. The candidate demonstrates the correct method to unlock and install new keys, additional keys, or to perform an emergency key change.
4. The candidate utilizes new keys; selects keys in MSC when old key is not deleted.

### Performance Steps

Perform the following steps to install new keys or perform a key change:

1. Save a copy of the MSC Key Loader to your software archive after installing new keys, or use this copy to perform a key change.
2. Run the installer program. Apply password to unlock installer. Read and accept the license. Install to the default C:\MSC location.
3. Note the Key Loader application will start before installation is complete. Do not close the installer at this time.
4. Identify the passphrase for the specific key you wish to load. Type the passphrase into the text box labeled "Enter Passphrase to Unlock Key". Press Unlock Key. Repeat this step for each key you are authorized/instructed to load.
5. View the bottom text box and validate the desired key is loaded into the Local Key Database.
6. When complete, close the Key-Loader application by pressing the X. Then press Finish on the installer program. Pressing Finish will remove the Key-Loader from your computer system.

### Training and Evaluation:

The mentor or trainer will provide the candidate:

- a. The MSC Key-Loader software
- b. The key passphrase sheet
- c. Individualized instruction and feedback

The candidate demonstrates successful completion of the PM to the Trainer or Mentor

### Performance Measures (PM):

1. Saved copy of Key Loader Installer to software archive
2. Successfully unlocked and installed Key Loader application.
3. Identified and entered correct passphrase for each desired key into Key Loader software. Validated key was installed to Local Key Database.
4. Closed Key Loader application and then pressed finish on the Installer program.
5. Selects proper key in MSC software before transmitting.

|    |       |
|----|-------|
| GO | NO GO |
| GO | NO GO |
| GO | NO GO |
| GO | NO GO |
| GO | NO GO |

### Evaluation Guidance:

Candidates passing all PMs receive a GO. If the candidate does not meet any PM, demonstrate the correct procedure and describe how to do it correctly. Have the candidate perform the PMs until they achieve the standard.

### References:

#### Required

- Video content, <https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources>

**Warnings:** None



## Information for Trainers and Mentors

The Mentor will facilitate a discussion of the video content referenced below:



## Resources

ATP 6-02.53  
Techniques for Tactical Radio Operations (Appendix I)  
Radio Operating Procedures

Video Content on <https://www.usarmy.mars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources>

AM-7 Job Aid, Check into a Radio Net



## Additional Notes

Success depends on a properly functioning and effective high frequency (HF) communications system capable of operating in radio telephone mode for distances up to 600 miles and consistently achieving Quality of Service of at least Good Readable. High levels of local Electro Magnetic Interference (EMI) must be resolved before attempting this task.



## Key Takeaway

The Candidate performs basic tasks in a radio net utilizing modern technique currently utilized by US Army.

**Task Number:** SL1-6

**Task Title:**

Communicate in a Radio Net

### Action:

Communicate in a Radio Net

### Condition:

Given: A properly operating radio set and antenna capable of achieving desired Quality of Service per AM-6. The network schedule and AM6 Annex D Communications Card.

### Standards:

Perform Radio Telephone functions in a radio net IAW Army Training Publication (ATP) 6-02.53 Appendix I.

### Performance Steps:

1. Established communications with the net control station at correct time and frequency. Verbalizes radio call using appropriate technique and pro-words. Does not pause between pro-word "this is" and call sign.
2. Utilize full call signs only when required and abbreviated call signs appropriately without specific direction to do so. Discontinues use of call signs when communications is in progress.
3. Answers a radio call from another station. Responds to interrogatives and directives appropriately.
4. Makes a radio call to another station. Requests permission from Net Control while Directed Net is in effect.
5. Request a radio check from another station. Respond appropriately to a radio check.
6. Makes a log containing the call sign and traffic listed by each station in the net. Copies by intercept all traffic sent on the net.

### Training and Evaluation:

The mentor or trainer will provide the candidate:

- a. All required references
- b. The net schedule and frequency list
- c. Individualized instruction and feedback following practice sessions.

The candidate demonstrates successful completion of the PM to the Trainer or Mentor

### Performance Measures (PM):

1. Correctly enters the radio net at the appropriate time and respond to net calls. Provides log showing all activity and traffic on the net. Leaves the net at request or by direction.
2. Verbalizes call-signs correctly. Does not pause following the pro-word This Is and the call sign. Uses full call sign only when required and uses abbreviated call sign. Discontinues use of call sign when communication is in progress. Utilizes call signs only in radio communications.
3. Correctly performs authentication and challenge procedure.
4. Correctly makes and answers radio calls with another station.
5. Correctly makes a radio check with another station.
6. Correctly verbalizes phonetic alphabet, pro-words correctly and consistently demonstrates good, concise voice technique.

GO

NO  
GO

GO

NO  
GO

GO

NO  
GO

GO

NO  
GO

GO

NO  
GO

GO

NO  
GO

### Evaluation Guidance:

Candidates passing all PMs receive a GO. If the candidate does not meet any PM, demonstrate the correct procedure and describe how to do it correctly. Have the candidate perform the PMs until they achieve the standard.

### References:

#### Required

- ATP 6-02.53 Techniques for Tactical Radio Operation (Appendix I)
- AM-6 Annex D Communications Card
- AM-7 Job Aid: Check into a Radio Net

#### Recommended

AM 6 Army MARS Net Plan

**Warnings:** None





## Resources

Candidates should review video material at the link provided in the task sheet.



## Additional

### Notes:

The videos demonstrate variation in the application of the procedure. For instance, CPT DeLeon instructs to use ROGER in radio checks while the evaluator in the following video responds to a radio check by saying LIMA CHARLIE. Inconsistencies such as these are inconsequential.

When a VMF template is not available in MSC messages should be written out on paper before sending.

The candidate shall prepare for this task by writing out copy of the example messages demonstrated in the videos and practice until they can correctly copy the messages in the videos.

Focus on good speech technique and concise manner and correct inappropriate/unnecessary use of pro-words. Use the example videos as a guide.

It is preferred to under-use the pro-word FIGURES than to over use it.

It is uncommon to use GENADMIN for voice messages. When an existing VMF does not apply, the messages should be sent free form between BREAKS.

**Task Number:** SL1-7

**Task Title:**

Send and Receive a Radio Telephone Message

### Action:

Send and receive radio telephone messages using Voice Message Formats

### Condition:

Given: Field Manual (FM) 6-99 US Army Report and Message Formats and an operating HF radio system capable of the AM-6, para 3 Minimum Quality of Service.

### Standards:

1. Correctly identify the appropriate Voice Message Format (VMF) template.
2. Speaks clearly at appropriate speed with good diction and pauses appropriately, sending a message with 100 percent accuracy at writing speed.
3. Correctly transcribes a clearly spoken message at a speed of at least "writing speed."
4. Uses procedure words appropriately, avoids using I SPELL and FIGURES when the format and structure of the information is expected by the receiving station. Correctly reads back the message at reading speed.
5. Sends long messages one line at a time. Correctly uses words HOW COPY, I COPY, GOOD COPY when sending and reading back a message.

### Performance Steps

Perform the following steps to send and receive a radio telephone message:

1. Based on the content of the information to be transmitted, select the appropriate VMF, ICS213, or use free text format. Write the message out. The receiving station shall be prepared with a good quality writing tool and notepad, or a word processor system.
2. Make a preliminary call to the other station which includes the call signs of the sending and receiving stations, and the pro-word MESSAGE or the title of the appropriate VMF. The receiving station shall have the VMF ready and say SEND IT. Information that is sent in the preliminary call does not have to be re-sent in the following transmission.
3. If the sending and receiving parties are the same as the originator and addressee, skip the From and To lines. Say the message to the other station using good voice technique. Preface each line with the line number or line heading, but not both. Say BREAK and pause between each line or say HOW COPY OVER. The receiving station shall write out the message and request any fills using the pro-words SAY AGAIN, ALL AFTER, ALL BEFORE.
4. Use I SPELL and FIGURES only when the spelling of a word is uncommon, the word is not understood, or if the expression of numerals is not expected in the context of the message.
5. End the transmission of the message or the line by saying HOW COPY – OVER. The receiving station will say I COPY and read back the entire message at reading speed. If the receiving station's copy is correct, the transmitting station will say GOOD COPY.

### Training and Evaluation:

Candidate shall demonstrate receiving and sending a VMF message by radio telephone on a good quality HF radio circuit. The Trainer/Mentor provides the candidate:

- a. All required references
- b. Factual information to transmit by radio.
- c. Individualized instruction and feedback following practice sessions.

The candidate demonstrates successful completion of the PM to the Trainer or Mentor.

### Performance Measures (PM):

1. Transmitted a message using a VMF template, used good voice technique, and correct procedure while maximizing brevity according to the performance steps.
2. Successfully received a VMF message with 100% accuracy according to the performance steps.

GO

NO-GO

GO

NO-GO

### Evaluation Guidance:

Candidates passing all PMs receive a GO. If the candidate does not meet any PM, demonstrate the correct procedure and describe how to do it correctly. Have the candidate perform the PMs until they achieve the standard.

### References:

- ATP 6-02.53 Annex I <https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources>
- US Army FM 6-99 <https://www.usarmymars.org/resources/references-public>
- Video content, <https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources>

**Warnings:** None

**Notes:**



## Resources

Instructions for operation of MSC Chat are provided in the application's menu bar selection "Help".



## Additional Notes:

Chats are station to station text messages that are generally informal in nature and contain operationally necessary information.

While chats do not replace voice communications, they can offer encrypted cover and ability to communicate when channel conditions do not support voice.

Chats are also very precise, protected by checksum, and can ensure correct copy of critical information. Chats are useful for sending information such as Response Strips to a collection point.

Chats can also be used to send situational information when the Net Control Station polls the net. This is particularly useful when such information requires encrypted cover because it is personal in nature (a telephone number) or the aggregate of the information should be denied to adversaries (initial assessment of a complex catastrophe).

Unless sending code groups or formatted data such as response strips or MGRS grids, use plain language in easily understood words and sentences to express thoughts, ideas and information. For instance, if checking into the net, simply write "checking into the net"

| Task Number: SL1-8                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  | Task Title: Send and Receive using Chat |                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <b>Action:</b><br>Send and receive a text message using Chat                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |  |                                         |                                              |
| <b>Condition:</b><br>Given: Loaded and operating MSC Software suite with appropriate encryption keys.<br>An operating HF radio system capable of the AM-6, para 3 Minimum Quality of Service.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |                                         |                                              |
| <b>Standards:</b><br>1. Differentiate between information that should be sent in a formal Message Object and a chat.<br>2. Utilizes the MSC Chat (CC) application and concise plain language expression of thoughts, ideas or information.<br>3. Always checks to ensure appropriate encryption policy is in place prior to transmitting.<br>4. Always selects compression when encryption is utilized. Selects appropriate transmission speed and interleave based on channel, band conditions, and message payload. (Relay may be required)<br>5. Transmits data at the appropriate time following preliminary voice call.<br>6. Validate received chats are correct using by reading the status of the checksum in CC. Request resend on information that includes data sets, coordinates, code groups or other mixed groups and numerals where the meaning can be corrupted by errors. |  |                                         |                                              |
| <b>Performance Steps</b><br>Perform the following steps to use Chat:<br>1. Send Chats from the MSC Chat (CC) application. Use the Chat group box towards the bottom of the CC window. Type concise expression of thoughts, ideas, or information into the Chat text box using plain language that is readily understood.<br>2. Check that the encryption policy is in place prior to transmitting.<br>3. If appropriate, make a voice radio call prior to sending the chat. This is situational.<br>4. Select appropriate modem speed and interleave based on channel condition. Short Interleave is used with short text messages unless channel conditions require Long Interleave.<br>5. Read chats on the MSC Chat text box. Note status of checksum and request resend when checksum fails. Provide feedback on quality of channel if a change in modem speed is required.            |  |                                         |                                              |
| <b>Training and Evaluation:</b><br>The trainer shall monitor and evaluate two-way chat/text messaging between the Candidate and another Auxiliarist's station on a HF radio circuit.<br><br>The Trainer/Mentor provides the Candidate individualized instruction and feedback following practice sessions. The CANDIDATE demonstrates successful completion of the PM to the Trainer or Mentor.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |                                         |                                              |
| <b>Performance Measures (PM):</b><br>1. Correctly selected appropriate information / communications for the chat using concise, plain language expression.<br><br>2. Transmits a chat and correctly utilizes the MSC Chat application, checks encryption policy, and selects appropriate modem speed and interleave based on channel conditions.<br><br>3. Receives and reads a chat in the MSC Chat application.<br><br>4. Observes checksum and requests a resend when a checksum error is present and the information in the chat may be in question.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  | GO<br><br>GO<br><br>GO<br><br>GO        | NO-GO<br><br>NO-GO<br><br>NO-GO<br><br>NO-GO |
| <b>Evaluation Guidance:</b><br>Candidates passing all PMs receive a GO. If the candidate does not meet any PM, demonstrate the correct procedure and describe how to do it correctly. Have the candidate perform the PMs until they achieve the standard.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  |                                         |                                              |
| <b>References:</b> n/a                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |                                         |                                              |
| <b>Warnings:</b><br>None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |                                         |                                              |
| <b>Notes:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |                                         |                                              |



## Resources

Instructions for operation of Message Machine are provided in the application's menu bar selection "Help".



## Additional Notes:

Digest is a MD-5 cryptographic hash of the message text which establishes the end to end integrity of the Message Object. Without Digest, errors may be introduced during relay and passed along to the final dictation. Digest prohibits "cut and paste" processing of the Message Object, ensuring it is processed entirely inside the MSC software and the radio operators handling relay are unable to accidentally or purposefully edit the content.

Digest differs from Checksum in that a cryptographic hash represents the text in a unique and non-repeating way. A checksum can represent several variations of text, although it is statistically unlikely these variations are similar. Checksum is used on transmission to determine the text sent by the transmitting station does not contain errors or "hits" from transmission over the radio circuit.

**Task Number:** SL1-9

**Task Title:**

Receive and Forward a Message

### Action:

Receive and forward a Message Object.

### Condition:

Given: Loaded and operating MSC Software suite with appropriate encryption keys.  
An operating HF radio system capable of the AM-6, para 3 Minimum Quality of Service. An HF radio net. A properly formatted 16L CODRESS message with routing indicators.

### Standards:

1. Receive a radio teletype message sent in MIL-STD data mode with 100% accuracy.
2. Ensure message is processed into Message Machine software.
3. Correctly screen and disseminate a 16L CODRESS message without decoding the message to viewing the FROM and TO Plain Language addresses.

### Performance Steps

Perform the following steps:

1. Receive a message from another station using the MIL-STD data mode.
2. Review the message in Message Machine, noting correct Checksum and Digest. If Checksum fails, have the other station re-transmit the message. If Digest fails but Checksum is good, advise the other station their copy of the message has an invalid hash and request they obtain a good copy of the message.
3. Using only the routing indicators on the message and Message Creator Address book, determine the destination for the messages and net the message must be relayed to.
4. Establish communications with the appropriate net.
5. Check encryption policy and key. Select appropriate modem speed. Transmit the message from the Message Machine to that net using the MIL-STD data mode.

### Training and Evaluation:

The trainer shall monitor and evaluate the reception and relay of Message Objects on a HF radio net.

The Trainer/Mentor provides the Candidate individualized instruction and feedback following practice sessions. The Candidate demonstrates successful completion of the PM to the Trainer or Mentor.

### Performance Measures (PM):

1. Received the Message Object and validated both checksum and MD5 hash (Digest) are valid. The trainee either demonstrates or verbalizes to the trainer action required to correct a bad Checksum or Digest condition.
2. Reviews the Routing Indicators and determines the destination or nearest station to the destination. Candidate does not utilize the names or Plain Language Addresses in the "From" and "To" lines to determine routing.
3. Reviews the network topology and correctly determines to which station and on what frequency the Message Object must be transmitted; establishes communications with that station.
4. Checks encryption policy and selects appropriate modem speed and interleave based on channel conditions; transmits the message from the Message Machine to the appropriate station.

GO

NO-GO

GO

NO-GO

GO

NO-GO

GO

NO-GO

### Evaluation Guidance:

Candidates passing all PMs receive a GO. If the candidate does not meet any PM, demonstrate the correct procedure and describe how to do it correctly. Have the candidate perform the PMs until they achieve the standard.

**References:** n/a

### Warnings:

None

### Notes:



## Resources

Instructions for operation of Message Creator and Message Machine are provided in each application's menu bar selection "Help".



## Additional Notes:

The MSC Message Creator workflow prioritizes the information content before formatting headers. The workflow is to first draft the message before selecting a header.

Utilize the 16L format that contains the least header overhead required to relay the message to its destination. Rule of thumb is to use 16L Simple when Routing Indicators / Call Signs are redundant to the TO and FROM plain language addresses. Utilize the 16L Full when Routing Indicators / Call Signs are not unique to the Plain Language Addresses on the To and From lines.

Once a message in MC is created, it is a static "Message Object" which cannot be changed. The digest ensures that the message content is not changed, and prohibits cut-pasting of text when handling the message.

Message Objects are stored, logged and tracked in the Message Machine's data base. Do not transmit the message directly from MC to the CP.

| Task Number: SL1-10                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  | Task Title:<br>Draft and Send a USMTF Message using MSC |                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>Action:</b><br>Draft and Send a USMTF message using MSC software                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  |                                                         |                                 |
| <b>Condition:</b><br>Given: Loaded and operating MSC Software suite with appropriate encryption keys.<br>An operating HF radio system capable of the AM-6 Minimum Quality of Service.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |                                                         |                                 |
| <b>Standards:</b><br>1. Correctly identify the appropriate USMTF template, or free form text, based on the kind of data that will be sent.<br>2. Follows workflow in Message Creator (MC) to create a message, starting with the message content. Correctly enters data into the MC application. Selects From and To addresses from address book, selects Precedence and classification if applicable. Selects the appropriate header template for the network with least overhead.<br>3. Always send the Message Object to Message Machine (MM) for logging and storage. Never sends a Message Object directly from MC.<br>4. Always check to ensure appropriate encryption policy is in place prior to transmitting.<br>5. Always select compression when encryption is utilized. Select appropriate transmission speed and interleave based on channel, propagation, and message payload.<br>6. Transmits data at the appropriate time following preliminary voice call. |  |                                                         |                                 |
| <b>Performance Steps</b><br>Perform the following steps:<br>1. Utilize MC to create a Message Object using USMTF or other formats.<br>2. Utilize search bar in Addressing Tab to easily locate desired addressees.<br>3. Select appropriate 16L header.<br>4. Send Message Object to MM.<br>5. Always check appropriate encryption key and encryption policy is in place prior to transmitting.<br>6. Make appropriate voice radio call, or preliminary call, prior to sending message.<br>7. Transmit the Message Object from MM. Communicate with the other station to determine they have good copy of the message.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |                                                         |                                 |
| <b>Training and Evaluation:</b><br>The trainer shall provide the candidate factual information to transmit by radio in which the candidate shall demonstrate receiving and sending a text message by radio teletype on a good quality HF radio circuit.<br>The Trainer/Mentor provides the candidate:<br>a. All required references<br>b. Individualized instruction and feedback following practice sessions.<br>The candidate demonstrates successful completion of the PM to the Trainer or Mentor.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |                                                         |                                 |
| <b>Performance Measures (PM):</b><br>1. Created a Message Object in MC using a USMTF template and sent the message to MM prior to transmission.<br>2. Checked encryption settings, set modem for appropriate speed, and interleave based on channel conditions, and established voice communications prior to transmitting the message to another station.<br>3. Transmit message and communicate with other station to determine good copy of the message.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  | GO<br><br>GO<br><br>GO                                  | NO-GO<br><br>NO-GO<br><br>NO-GO |
| <b>Evaluation Guidance:</b><br>Candidates passing all PMs receive a GO. If the candidate does not meet any PM, demonstrate the correct procedure and describe how to do it correctly. Have the candidate perform the PMs until they achieve the standard.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |                                                         |                                 |
| <b>References:</b><br>• ATP 6-02.53 Annex I <a href="https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources">https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources</a><br>• US Army FM 6-99 <a href="https://www.usarmymars.org/resources/references-public">https://www.usarmymars.org/resources/references-public</a><br>• Video content, <a href="https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources">https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |  |                                                         |                                 |
| <b>Warnings:</b><br>None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |  |                                                         |                                 |
| <b>Notes:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |  |                                                         |                                 |





## Resources

Instructions for operation of Message Machine are provided in the application's menu bar selection "Help".



## Additional Notes:

CODRES is the standard for evaluating routing a message. In a CODRESS message, the TO and FROM Plain Language Addresses are covered in the code groups and not a visible clue to routing.

Listen to the TGN net first!

Take some time to just listen to a few TGN net sessions to get the feel of how the TGN operates and how it is different from region operations.

Try to identify the good operators on the TGN. Pay attention to transmission speeds used over long distances, get a feel for what works at different signal strengths.

Tactical call signs are used to identify most of the functional roles for each station in the TGN. To maintain efficiency, only those stations with established roles normally check into this net.

Operating HF over the long distances to stations outside your region require different technical configurations than internal regional communications. These long distance communications capabilities are MARS primary focus. Establish a strategy to focus your antennas power on low take off angle on higher frequencies.

If you can't hear them you can't talk to them. Before attempting long distance communications with HF you must first ensure you have a good receive site that is free of Electro Magnetic Interference. Eliminate (or turn off) sources of EMI from your home.

**Task Number:** SL1-11

**Task Title:**

Relay a Message to the TransGlobal Net

### Action:

Relay a Message to a National Network

### Condition:

Given: Loaded and operating MSC Software suite with appropriate encryption keys. An operating HF radio system capable of the AM-6, para 3 Minimum Quality of Service over long distances. Radio frequencies for the TransGlobal Network (TGN) or other national network. A properly formatted 16L CODRESS message with routing indicators.

### Standards:

1. Check into the TGN network using the appropriate tactical call sign.
2. Lists traffic with the TGN Net Control or Major Relay station using voice procedure.
3. Receives any traffic TGN is holding for the respective Region.

### Performance Steps

Perform the following steps:

1. Receive a message in which the routing requires relay to the TGN. Ensure the message is processed into your Message Machine and has good Digest and Checksum before taking the message to another net.
2. Review TGN schedule and check into the TGN at the appropriate time using the tactical call sign for the Region's Minor Relay Station. Do not say your regular call sign when using the tactical call sign. Contact the Net Control or Major Relay and list your traffic.
3. Establish radio contact with the station. Check encryption policy, select compression, and select appropriate modem speed before transmitting. Transmit the message when directed. Ensure receiving station has good copy and valid checksum.
4. When complete, return to your Region net and advise the Region NCS that traffic is passed. List any traffic for the region you received from the TGN.

### Training and Evaluation:

The trainer shall monitor and evaluate the reception and relay of Message Objects on a HF radio net. The Trainer/Mentor provides the candidate:

- a. The TGN net schedule and Frequency List
- b. Individualized instruction and feedback following practice sessions.

The candidate demonstrates successful completion of the PM to the Trainer or Mentor.

### Performance Measures (PM):

1. Reviews messages to be passed up to TGN in the Message Machine. Ensure digest and checksum is good.
2. Check into the TGN at the appropriate time and frequency on the date as directed by the Region NCS. Correctly uses the tactical call sign assigned to the Region's Minor Relay Station.
3. Lists traffic with the TGN NCS or Major Relay Station. Checks encryption policy before transmitting, utilizes compression, and transmits message using the MIL-STD data mode when directed. Ensures message is correctly received by receiving station, re-transmits as required.
4. Accepts any traffic for the Region, ensure it correctly processes into Message Machine with good checksum and digest. Returns to Region Net, inform NCS the traffic is passed and list any traffic for the region received from the TGN

GO

NO-GO

GO

NO-GO

GO

NO-GO

GO

NO-GO

### Evaluation Guidance:

Candidates passing all PMs receive a GO. If the candidate does not meet any PM, demonstrate the correct procedure and describe how to do it correctly. Have the candidate perform the PMs until they achieve the standard.

**References:** n/a

### Warnings:

None

### Notes:



## Resources

ATP 6-02.53.  
AM 6, Army MARS Net  
Plan with Annexes  
AM 6 Job Aid – Call A radio  
Net.



## Additional

### Notes:

Listen to your Region's  
good Net Control Stations.

Good Net Control Stations  
(NCS) have a slightly  
different approach. What  
they have in common is  
they are in charge, do not  
display emotion or appear  
to get frustrated, are  
efficient and concise in their  
instructions and  
communications.

NCS is an authoritative  
task. Your job is to tell  
people what to do. Direct,  
do not ask. Tell someone  
to make a net call. Tell  
someone THEY ARE the  
alternate Net Control  
Station. Be direct about  
what you want someone to  
do and just tell them to do  
it.

Be concise. Use as few  
words as possible. Saying  
"Additional Stations"  
following a net call up get  
the same results as saying  
"Additional Stations For the  
Net". Avoid preambles and  
scripts; they are not  
necessary. The other  
MARS stations know what  
to do when you prompt  
them with the correct pro-  
words.

All Stations This Net,  
This is a Directed Net,  
Over

Translated means,

Hey Everyone.  
I'm in Charge.  
Answer Me Now!

**Task Number:** SL1-12

**Task Title:**

Call a Radio Net

### Action:

Call a Radio Net

### Condition:

Given: An operating HF radio system capable of the AM-6 Minimum Quality of Service throughout the Region, the network schedule, AM 6 Annex D Communications Card, and an assignment to Net Control Station duty at a specific date/time.

### Standards:

Correctly perform duties as Net Control Station (NCS) according to ATP 6-02.53.

### Performance Steps

Perform the following steps:

1. Establish the radio net at the assigned time and frequency.
2. Dispose of all traffic and information for the net.
3. Close the net once all business is complete

### Training and Evaluation:

The Trainer/Mentor will provide assistance in scheduling a specific date/time for the candidate to perform the net control functions.

The Trainer/Mentor provides the candidate:

- a. All required references
- b. The Region/ State net schedule
- c. Individualized instruction and feedback following practice sessions

The candidate demonstrates successful completion of the PM to the Trainer or Mentor.

### Performance Measures (PM):

1. Opened net at correct time and appropriate frequency. Made a net call by saying "All Stations This Net" and included statement "This Is a Directed Net". Directed at least one other station to make a net call.
2. Acknowledged stations that answer the net call. Appointed an alternate net control station.
3. Directed the disposition of pending messages, traffic, and information according to precedence. Polled the net for information. Made statement "this is a free net" when directed activity is concluded.
4. Prepared and transmitted COMSPOT for the net or directed another station to prepare and transmit the COMSPOT

GO

NO-  
GO

GO

NO-  
GO

GO

NO-  
GO

GO

NO-  
GO

### Evaluation Guidance:

Candidates passing all PMs receive a GO. If the candidate does not meet any PM, demonstrate the correct procedure and describe how to do it correctly. Have the candidate perform the PMs until they achieve the standard.

### References:

- ATP 6-02.53 Annex I <https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources>
- AM-6 Annex D Communications Card
- AM-7 Job Aid. Call A Radio Net. <https://www.usarmymars.org/training/skill-level-1-basic-training-resources>

### Warnings:

None

### Notes:



**DA Form 5164-R: (Hands-On Evaluation).**

|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                   |                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| HANDS-ON EVALUATION (DA Form 5164-Rv)                                                                                                                                                          |                                                   | DATE:                 |
| TASK TITLE                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                   | TASK NUMBER           |
| Basic / Individual TASKS                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                   | <b>LEVEL 1</b>        |
| ITEM                                                                                                                                                                                           | PERFORMANCE STEP TITLE                            | (CIRCLE ONE)          |
| SL1-1                                                                                                                                                                                          | National Incident Management System               | GO / NO-GO            |
| SL1-2                                                                                                                                                                                          | Orientation                                       | GO / NO-GO            |
| SL1-4                                                                                                                                                                                          | MSC Software (MSC Tasks 1-1 through 1-7)          | GO / NO-GO            |
| SL1-5                                                                                                                                                                                          | Load Encryption Keys                              | GO / NO-GO            |
| SL1-6                                                                                                                                                                                          | Communicate in a Radio Net (ATP 6-02.53)          | GO / NO-GO            |
| SL1-7                                                                                                                                                                                          | Receive and Send a Voice Message (FM 6-99)        | GO / NO-GO            |
| SL1-8                                                                                                                                                                                          | Send and Receive using Chat                       | GO / NO-GO            |
| SL1-9                                                                                                                                                                                          | Receive and forward a message using MSC software  | GO / NO-GO            |
| SL1-10                                                                                                                                                                                         | Draft and Send a USMTF message using MSC software | GO / NO-GO            |
| SL1-11                                                                                                                                                                                         | Relay a message to a National Network             | GO / NO-GO            |
| SL1-12                                                                                                                                                                                         | Call A Radio Net (ATP 6-02.53)                    | GO / NO-GO            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                   |                       |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                   |                       |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                   |                       |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                   |                       |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                   |                       |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                   |                       |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                   |                       |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                   |                       |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                   |                       |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                   |                       |
| Score a GO if the individual passes all performance measures. Score a NO-GO if the individual fails any performance measure. For a NO-GO, show what was done wrong and how to do it correctly. |                                                   |                       |
| EVALUATOR'S NAME:                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                   | ORGANIZATION:         |
| TRAINEE'S NAME:                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                   | STATUS:<br>GO / NO-GO |

**GLOSSARY**

|          |                                         |
|----------|-----------------------------------------|
| ACP      | Allied Communications Publications      |
| AM       | Army Mars                               |
| AMARS    | Army Military Auxiliary Radio Systems   |
| ATP      | Army Training Publication               |
| BTC      | Basic Training Course                   |
| CC       | MSC Chat                                |
| COMSPOT  | Communications Spot Report              |
| CP       | Communications Processor                |
| DA       | Department of the Army                  |
| DSCA     | Defense Support to Civil Authorities    |
| EW       | Encryption Wizard                       |
| FM       | Field Manual                            |
| GENADMIN | General Administration (message)        |
| HADR     | Humanitarian Assistance Disaster Relief |
| HF       | High Frequency                          |
| IAW      | in accordance with                      |
| ICS      | Incident Command System                 |
| MARS     | Military Auxiliary Radio Systems        |
| MC       | Message Creator                         |
| MET      | Mission Essential Tasks                 |
| MIL-STD  | Military Standard                       |
| MSC      | MARS Standard Communications            |
| MM       | Message Machine                         |
| NCS      | Net Control Station                     |
| NETPLAN  | net plan                                |
| NIMS     | National Incident Management System     |
| OPSEC    | Operational Security                    |
| PM       | performance measures                    |
| RC       | Response Collector                      |
| SL       | Skill Level                             |
| TGN      | TransGlobal Network                     |
| USMTF    | U.S. Message Text Formats               |